



FACE TO FACE

You can see marine life close up if you take a trip in a glass-bottomed boat or a tourist submarine. Or try snorkeling—it's amazing what you can see once you're below the ocean's surface, especially if you snorkel over a coral reef; but don't touch anything—especially sponges or coral—because you may damage or even kill it.



Flukes (tail parts) of a humpback whale

WHALE WATCHING
Various companies, especially in Canada and the United States, organize whale-watching vacations, giving you the chance of seeing whales in their natural environment. The tourists pictured left are observing humpback whales off the coast of Alaska.

MARINE SANCTUARIES

Marine sanctuaries are areas of ocean around coasts, established to protect local wildlife and educate the public about the marine environment. Why not plan a trip to a sanctuary or find out more about them through the Internet? You can also join organizations working to protect and conserve the world's oceans.

Otter in the Monterey Bay National Marine Sanctuary, off the coast of California



Places to visit

SEA WORLD—ORLANDO, FLORIDA; SAN ANTONIO, TEXAS; SAN DIEGO, CALIFORNIA

Aquatic-themed amusement parks with three locations. See:

- seal and otter shows
- dolphin presentations
- unique exhibits at each park

NATIONAL AQUARIUM, BALTIMORE, MARYLAND

See stingrays, electric eels, puffins, razorbills, sharks, and more, including:

- a magnificent indoor coral reef in a 335,000-gallon (1.27 million-liter) tank
- a giant Pacific octopus

NEW YORK AQUARIUM, BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

Exhibits draw on ongoing scientific research and feature more than 8,000 animals. Visit:

- the Alien Stingers exhibit on jellyfish
- sea lions in the Aquatheater presentations
- animals from the local Hudson River

SHEDD AQUARIUM, CHICAGO, ILLINOIS

At the world's largest indoor aquarium, see:

- dolphin shows
- a coral reef exhibit, featuring divers hand-feeding the animals
- the Pacific Northwest Coast exhibit, featuring otters, seals, whales, and dolphins

MONTEREY BAY AQUARIUM, CALIFORNIA

Exhibits approximately 550 different species of animals and plants, and features:

- living kelp forest exhibit
- outer bay exhibit, with bluefin tuna, sharks, and sea turtles



Pewter pitcher from the Mary Rose